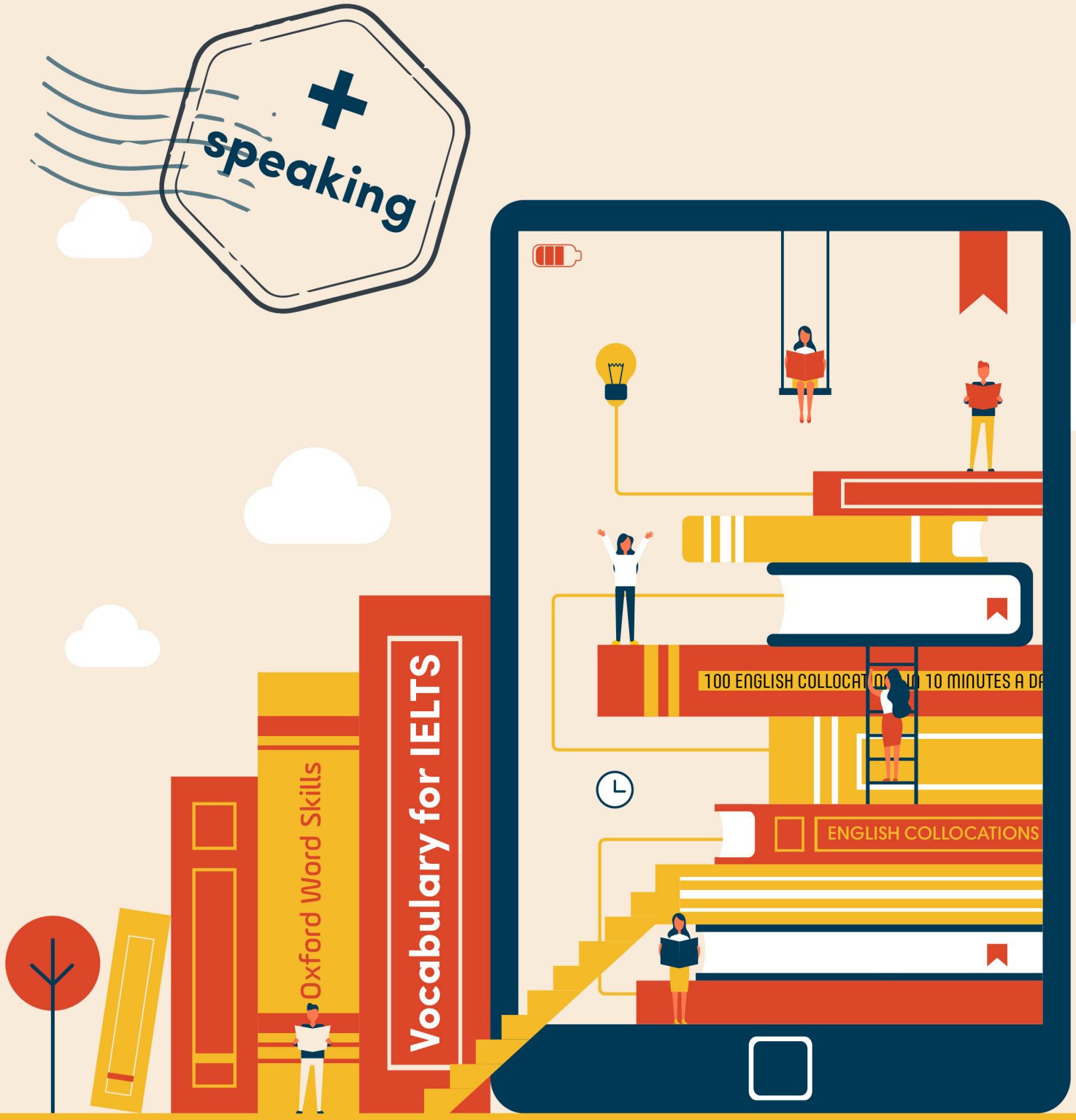
IELTS Up Words!

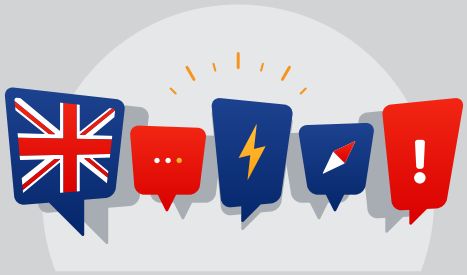
دوره لغات آیلتس

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Lesson 57: Tradition

Hi! Welcome to yet another lesson of IELTS Up Words with me, Yasi, from Lingemy.com. In the previous lesson, we talked about the important topic of government. Honestly, there is still so much more to learn about that topic; for example, it wouldn't hurt to know that governments are run based on different political systems, such as capitalism, in which citizens are not entitled to free healthcare, or a dictatorship, in which citizens are oppressed. So, keep reading on this topic on the Internet to learn even more.

Now as for this lesson, we will look at the topic of tradition. Tradition and culture are usually synonymous with festivals and celebrations, so let's answer a couple of questions about them.

Do you think every country must hold onto its traditional cultures?

Yes, I strongly believe that it is vital for every culture to preserve its traditions. Because if we stop observing traditional celebrations, or if we don't uphold them, we will soon lose our cultural identity. But it is probably best to protect them by letting customs evolve over time.

Do you think any festivals or celebrations in your country are over-commercialized or have lost their original meaning?

I think that some have lost their meaning; for example, look at Valentine's Day—a day originally meant for lovers to show their love. It has now turned into a day for exchanging expensive gifts. On the other hand, we have Yalda Night—the Iranian celebration of the winter solstice—that we cherish by getting together with family members and friends. Luckily, this tradition has remained intact, which brings me to the conclusion that there are still some customs or festivals that haven't changed for the worse.

Speaking Tip



Language of Uncertainty for Type Three Questions

The questions above are sample type three questions, and I answered the latter with a degree of uncertainty. I did not use words like “definitely” or “absolutely.” Instead, I approached the question differently by discussing both sides first and then concluding it by stating my opinion. This is a great way to develop your ideas and impress the examiner. However, I only advise learners with a great command of English to answer questions this way, as it is more difficult compared to the former type.

Useful language for this type of response:

1. On the other hand, some customs have been misinterpreted and should not be upheld anymore.
2. While this may be true, some customs have been misinterpreted and should not be upheld anymore.
3. I would say that it depends on the type of tradition because some of them have been misinterpreted and are not upheld correctly.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
tradition	a belief, principle, or way of acting that people in a particular society or group have	سنّت؛ رسم	the age-old/ rich/proud/long-standing tradition; to break with tradition
festivals	a special day or period, usually in memory of a religious event, with its own social activities	جشنواره‌ها؛ عیدها	Festivities a festive mood join in the festivities
to hold onto traditional cultures	to preserve and maintain traditional cultures	پایبندبودن به فرهنگ‌های قدیمی و بومی	
to preserve traditions	to keep traditions as they are; to keep traditions alive	حفظ‌کردن و زنده‌نگه‌داشتن سنّت‌ها	to protect/ safeguard traditions ;preservation (noun)
evolving customs	traditions and customs that develop over time	رسوم درحال‌تحول	changing customs
letting customs evolve	letting customs develop over time	اجازه بدیم رسوم تغییر و تحول داشته باشند	
observing traditional celebrations	performing or taking part in traditional celebrations	برپاداشتن جشن‌های سنّتی	participate in traditional celebrations
to uphold a tradition	to maintain a tradition	حفظ‌کردن یک سنّت	to uphold a custom/ practice

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
cultural identity	the identity or feeling of belonging to a group or culture	هویت فرهنگی	cultural heritage
over-commercialized	to commercialize to an excessive degree	بیش‌ازحد تجاری‌سازی‌شده	excessive commercialization
to cherish something	to hold something dear	مغتنم‌شمردن چیزی	to keep something in one's mind/heart
it has remained intact	it has remained untouched/not damaged	دست‌نخورده باقی مانده	remain unharmed/ unchanged; keep intact
it has changed for the worse	it has become more unpleasant or more difficult	بدتر شده است	
misinterpreted traditions	traditions that are interpreted or understood incorrectly	سنّت‌هایی که به غلط / اشتباه تعبیر شده‌اند	Misunderstood misinterpretation (noun)

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
it wouldn't hurt to know	used to mean that a person should know something	بهتر است بدانی؛ بد نیست بدانی	it would help to know
capitalism	an economic system based on private ownership of property and business	(نظام) سرمایه‌داری / سرمایه محوری	opposite: communism
to be entitled to something	having a right to something	مستحق چیزی بودن؛ صاحب حق چیزی بودن	Entitlement
dictatorship	government by a dictator	دیکتاتوری	totalitarian
to oppress the citizens	to keep the citizens in subjection and hardship, especially by the unjust exercise of authority	سرکوب‌کردن مردم	to suppress; to put down
to be synonymous with something	to be closely connected or associated with something	ارتباط نزدیک داشتن با چیز ی	to correspond with something
winter solstice	the day with the shortest period of daylight and longest night of the year	بلندترین شب سال	summer solstice
great command of English	having great knowledge of English	تسلط عالی بر انگلیسی	good/excellent/poor command of English



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